
‘Bold and inventive’ Canadian poet Anne Carson wins Nobel Literature Prize

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Alamy

Canadian poet, essayist and translator Anne Carson has been awarded this year’s Nobel Prize in Literature.

Carson, 76, is celebrated for works that often cross the boundaries between poetry, fiction and scholarship.

The Nobel Prize committee said they had selected her “for her bold and inventive oeuvre that, in playful dialogue with the classical tradition, has created new forms for contemporary literature”.

Carson responded by joking that the judges were “crazy” for honouring her. “I think they’re all crazy... Well, you know, it’s crazy,” she told public broadcaster RUV in Iceland, where she is currently staying.

The Nobel Prize is awarded for a lifetime's body of work and is regarded as the most prestigious award in global literature, with the winner receiving 12 million Swedish kronor (£900,000, \$1.2m).

Ingrid Carlberg, permanent secretary of the Swedish Academy, said she had broken the news to Carson on the phone shortly before the public announcement.

“She had time to tell me was that she is, for the moment, in Iceland, where she is listening to the wind,” Carlberg, said.

“She was taken by surprise but very happy. I could hear that in her voice.”



Getty Images: Anne Carson pictured in 1998

Born in Toronto in 1950, Carson lives in Michigan and has also held Icelandic citizenship since 2022.

Anders Olsson, chairman of the Swedish Academy's Nobel committee for Literature, praised the way Carson has “broken away from lyrical poetry bound to the narrative self and inspired new forms of contemporary literature”.

“This method of writing leads to playful and ironic works that move not only between classical and modern poetry but also between different genres and artforms,” he said.

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said Carson's win was “an extraordinary achievement and a proud moment for Canada”.

The writer's works feature “wit, imagination, and a style entirely her own,” Carney wrote on social media.

“She has brought ancient stories to new audiences and transformed the way we think about literature.”

Carson's notable works include *The Glass Essay*, *Autobiography of Red: A Novel in Verse*, *Nox*, *Float* and *The Beauty of the Husband: A Fictional Essay in 29 Tangos*.

In 2019, her performance piece *Norma Jeane Baker of Troy* drew a line between famous beauties from different historical periods - Helen of Troy and Marilyn Monroe.

In 2021, she released *The Trojan Women: A Comic*, a graphic retelling of Euripides' ancient story; and her translation of *Elektra* by Sophocles was staged starring Brie Larson in London last year.

She has been a professor of classics for more than 30 years and her writing is often inspired by Greek literature.

Her translations have often given a contemporary twist to ancient works.

"Her collaborations with visual artists and choreographers and with opera and theatre directors demonstrate the freedom with which she relates to literary expectations and rule systems," Olsson said.

"It is this that lies behind the outstanding importance her work since the 1990s has had for the international art and literature scene."

生词标注（新闻高频 + 词汇第二义项）

词	词性	中文	备注
oeuvre	n.	（作家、艺术家的）全部作品	"her bold and inventive oeuvre" 她大胆而富有创造力的全部作品；法语借词，文学评论高频，单复同形
bold	adj.	大胆的、无畏的	"Bold and inventive"（标题引语）；另义“粗体的”，如 bold type 粗体字
celebrated	adj.	闻名的、备受赞誉的	"is celebrated for works that often cross the boundaries" 因作品而闻名；be celebrated for 为第二义项，另义“庆祝”
cross the boundaries	phr.	跨越界限	"cross the boundaries between poetry, fiction and scholarship" 横跨

词	词性	中文	备注
			诗歌、小说与学术三个领域
scholarship	n.	学术、学问	“between poetry, fiction and scholarship” 在诗歌、小说与学术之间；第二义项“奖学金”（美式用法）
prestigious	adj.	有声望的、有威望的	“the most prestigious award in global literature” 全球文学界最负盛名的奖项；名词 prestige 声望
broke the news	phr.	把（消息）第一个告诉某人	“she had broken the news to Carson on the phone” 她打电话把消息告诉了卡森；break the news (to sb), broke 为 break 过去式
taken by surprise	phr.	感到意外	“She was taken by surprise but very happy.” 她感到意外，但非常高兴；take sb by surprise 使某人吃惊
permanent secretary	n.	常务秘书、常任秘书	“permanent secretary of the Swedish Academy” 瑞典学院常务秘书；政府及国际机构高级文官职称
bound to	v.	束缚于、受限于	“lyrical poetry bound to the narrative self” 束缚于叙事自我的抒情诗；bind（束缚）的过去分词
narrative	n. / adj.	叙事；叙事的	“the narrative self” 叙事性自我；文学研究与创作理论核心词
ironic	adj.	反讽的	“playful and ironic works” 戏谑而反讽的作品；名词 irony 反讽
genres	n.	体裁、门类	“between different genres and artforms” 在不同体裁与艺术形式

词	词性	中文	备注
			之间；文学分类核心词
drew a line between	phr.	在……之间建立联系	“drew a line between famous beauties” 把不同时代的著名美人勾连起来；draw 第二义项“串联、划出脉络”
retelling	n.	重述、重新演绎	“a graphic retelling of Euripides’ ancient story” 对欧里庇得斯古典故事的图像化重述；动词 retell
released	v.	发行、出版（作品）	“she released The Trojan Women: A Comic” 她出版《特洛伊妇女：漫画版》；新闻高频第二义项，另义“释放”
staged	v.	搬上舞台、上演	“was staged starring Brie Larson” 上演，由布丽·拉尔森主演；stage 名词“舞台”活用为动词“上演”
classics	n.	古典学、古希腊罗马研究	“a professor of classics for more than 30 years” 任古典学教授三十余年；classic 复数另义“经典作品”
feature	v.	以……为特色	“works feature ‘wit, imagination, and a style entirely her own’” 作品以机智、想象与独树一帜的风格见长；另义名词“特色、专题报道”
twist	n.	转折、新意	“given a contemporary twist to ancient works” 为古代作品赋予当代新意；第二义项“变化、转折”